Geidö

Magazine Vol.1 June 2025



FROM THE AUTHOR

Dear Reader,

Every journey begins not with a step, but with a spark—a photograph glimpsed, a scent remembered, a dream that refuses to sleep. This issue of *Geido* is for that spark. Whether you're flipping through from your favorite armchair or already halfway to somewhere, we hope to meet you where the yearning begins.

Our theme is Geidō—the way of art, of devotion, of moving through the world with quiet intention. Not simply about movement, but about how we move through the world—with presence, with attention, with reverence. Within these pages, you'll find more than destinations—you'll find the emotional landscapes that shape us slowly and deeply: the dusty hill towns of India where memory clings to sun-warmed stone, the hush of dawn in Bhutan where prayer flags flutter like breath, the winding streets of a French village where time seems to pause for beauty's sake, and a lone path through the pines of Nepal where something old in us begins to awaken.

In this issue we have made space for stillness—that teaches you to *be* somewhere, not just pass through.

Monolina Sarkar

Author, *Geidō*

Being Here

Reminiscing on Orhan Pamuk's *Memories of Distant Mountains*



Some books don't so much speak as *breathe*. You don't read them in a hurry—you let them sit beside you, like a quiet old friend who has stories to share if you care to listen. Orhan Pamuk's *Memories of Distant Mountains* is one such companion.

This is not a novel in any ordinary sense. It is a patchwork quilt of remembered hills and half-dreamed thoughts, stitched together by a Nobel Laureate who, it turns out, has a painter's soul and a child's eyes. Between the handwritten scrawls and wandering sketches, Pamuk shows us not just the places he's been, but the reflections of someone who has watched Istanbul change from his window, and watched himself change along with it.

He writes about loneliness the way some of us write about the weather—with quiet familiarity and the sense that it, too, will pass. One entry, accompanied by a watercolor of snow, simply notes the silence of the day. Another records a courtroom drawing—the memory of being prosecuted for telling the truth. Yet even this is rendered without bitterness. His anger, if it exists, is always softened by curiosity. There are many small joys here, too: buying pens in New York, watching birds in winter, scribbling the idea for a novel while waiting for tea. He tells us, gently, about the weight of words and the lightness of lines. And perhaps, most movingly, he lets us see how art—both written and drawn—can keep one company in a world that doesn't always understand the artist.

I thought of my own school notebooks as I turned the pages. The ones I once filled with doodles and daydreams during long afternoons. There is something reassuring in knowing that even grown-up writers—famous ones, no less—do much the same thing. Pamuk's drawings are often whimsical, sometimes solemn, and occasionally unfinished. But they are always honest.

Much like letters from a beloved pen friend (Jean Webster would have approved), these pages do not aim to impress—they aim to connect. And they do. So take your time with this book. Read it in bed, perhaps, or on a train as it climbs some sleepy hillside. It is not in a hurry. And neither should you be.

Landscapes, cityscapes, and interiors—especially views of Istanbul—pour from the page with a childlike immediacy, complemented by text that circles back on novel ideas, snippets of diary, or poetic impressions. The arrangement of entries "in emotional order" rather than chronological enhances the dreamlike quality of the collection, guiding readers through emotional resonance instead of dates He notes where he wrote each sentence, balances days of writing with bouts of self-doubt and writer's block, and even shares the mundane: "In the afternoons, I go to the Avery Library to write my novel….. These small windows into his routine are as compelling as his reflections on major events—his time teaching at Columbia, his work on The Museum of Innocence, and tensions with the Turkish state. He tells us, gently, about the weight of words and the lightness of lines. My love for the work, though we are from different countries, I believe is because he introduces me to a land that is fearless and heartfelt.

